Rekordbox → Pacemaker Sync

The beginner's guide for Mac

This app takes the playlists you've built in Rekordbox and puts them on your Tonium Pacemaker, music files included. You don't need any technical knowledge. Just follow the steps in order.

Rekordbox your playlists	→	**Editor Library** get them ready here	→	**Pacemaker** music on the device

One word to learn: the Pacemaker calls a playlist a **"case"**. Whenever you see "case" here, think "playlist".

> **Early version**
> This Mac version is brand new and hasn't been tried on a real Mac with a real Pacemaker yet. It has only passed automated tests. Your Rekordbox library and the music on your computer aren't changed by this app, but keep a backup of anything on your Pacemaker that you can't replace. If something goes wrong, see Part 9.

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Part 1: Download the app

Before you start

You need a Mac running **macOS 14.4 (Sonoma) or newer**, and your Pacemaker and its USB cable. To import your Rekordbox playlists, you also need Rekordbox 6 or 7, installed and opened at least once. Without Rekordbox, you can drag music in from Finder instead (see Part 7).

Which Mac do I have?

1. Click the **Apple logo** at the very top left of your screen, then **About This Mac**.
2. Note the macOS version. If it's older than 14.4, update it first under **System Settings** → **General** → **Software Update**. The app won't run on a Mac that can't update this far.
3. Look for the line starting **Chip** or **Processor** and use this table:

The window says	You have	Download the file ending in
Chip: Apple M1, M2, M3…	Apple Silicon	`-arm64.dmg`
Processor: …Intel…	Intel	`-intel.dmg`

Get the file

The app is free to download from the project's Releases page on GitHub. You don't need a GitHub account.

1. Go to the Releases page (if you're reading this on paper, the address is `github.com/clyttle85/rekordbox-pacemaker-sync/releases/latest`).
2. Scroll down to the section called **Assets**. If you can't see the files, click **Assets** to open it.
3. Click the name that matches your Mac: `RekordboxPacemakerSync-0.9.1-arm64.dmg` or `RekordboxPacemakerSync-0.9.1-intel.dmg`. Each is about 50 MB. A newer version may have a different number in its name.
4. Open your **Downloads** folder to find the **.dmg** file.

Part 2: Install and open it

Install

1. Double-click the **.dmg** file. A window opens showing the app and an **Applications** folder.
2. Drag **RekordboxPacemakerSync** onto the **Applications** folder.
3. Close that window. In the sidebar of any Finder window, click the small eject symbol next to **Rekordbox Pacemaker Sync**. You can now delete the .dmg file.

Open it for the first time

Apple blocks apps from developers who haven't registered with them, so your Mac will refuse to open this one at first. That's expected, and you only have to deal with it once.

1. Open your **Applications** folder and double-click **RekordboxPacemakerSync**.
2. A message says Apple could not verify the app. Click **Done**. Don't choose "Move to Trash".
3. Click the **Apple logo**, then **System Settings**, then **Privacy & Security** in the list on the left.
4. Scroll down to the **Security** section. Next to the message about RekordboxPacemakerSync, click **Open Anyway**.
5. Click **Open Anyway** again to confirm, then enter your Mac password or use Touch ID if asked.

> **If you don't see those buttons**
> **On macOS 14 (Sonoma)** the steps are simpler: right-click the app in Applications, choose **Open**, then click **Open** in the message.
> **No Open Anyway button?** Double-click the app again, then go straight back to Privacy & Security.

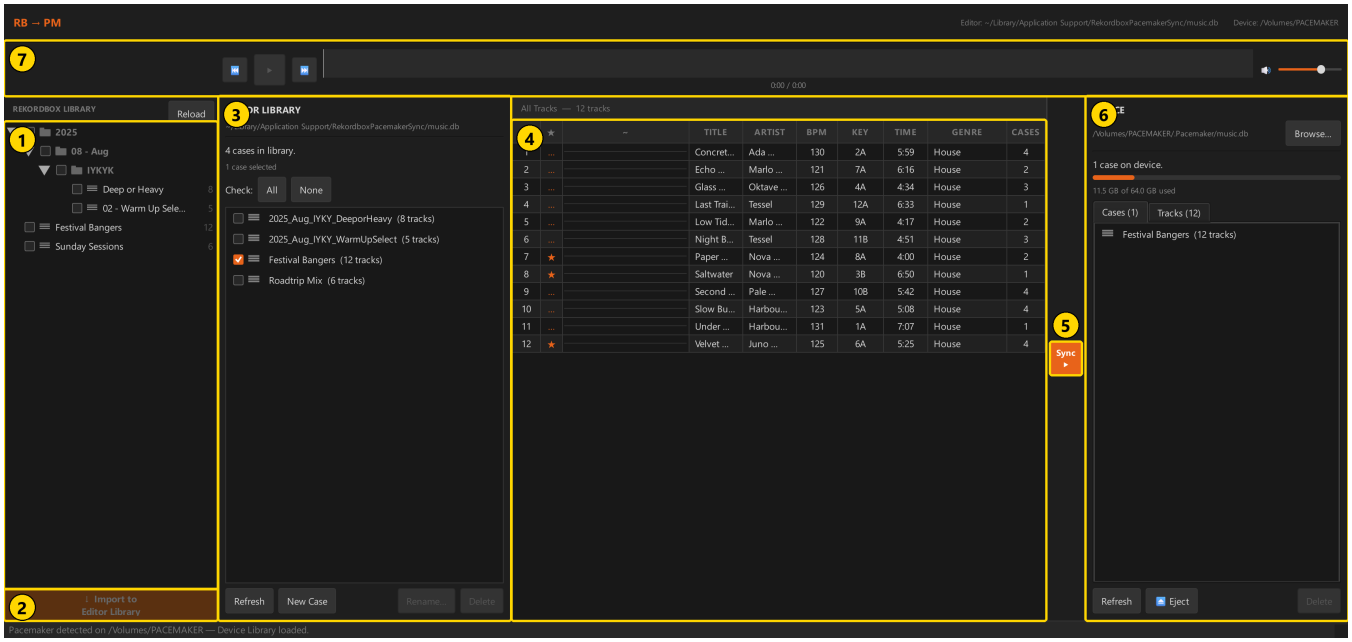
Say yes to permissions

The first time the app needs them, your Mac asks for permission to use **removable volumes** (your Pacemaker) and any of your **Documents, Downloads or Desktop** folders where music is stored. Click **Allow** each time. If you click the wrong thing, you can change it later: see Part 9.

Connect your Pacemaker

Plug the Pacemaker into your Mac with its USB cable and turn it on. Check it appears in the sidebar of a Finder window under **Locations**. The app checks for it every couple of seconds, so it doesn't matter whether you do this before or after opening the app.

Part 3: A quick tour of the screen



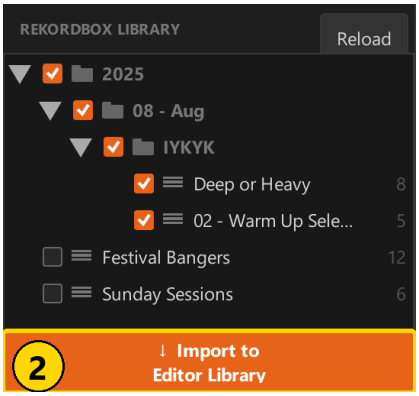
The real app, showing made-up music. Fonts and buttons look a little different on a Mac.

	What it is	What you do there
1	**Rekordbox Library**	Your Rekordbox folders and playlists. Tick the ones you want. The app only reads these and never changes them.
2	**Import to Editor Library**	Copies your ticked playlists across to area 3.
3	**Editor Library**	Your cases. Create, rename and delete them here, and tick the ones you want on the Pacemaker.
4	**Track list**	Click a case in area 3 to see and edit its tracks here. With no case open, it lists all your tracks.
5	**Sync**	Makes the Pacemaker match your ticks in area 3. It only lights up when a Pacemaker is connected.
6	**Device**	What's on your Pacemaker right now, and how full it is. The **Eject** button is here.
7	**Player**	Preview tracks through your Mac's speakers.

The bar along the very bottom of the window shows messages, such as "Pacemaker detected". The menus (**File** and **Debug**) are at the top of your Mac's screen, as with every Mac app.

Part 4: Import playlists from Rekordbox

Don't use Rekordbox? Skip to Part 7.



Each playlist becomes one case, with its tracks in the same order. Nothing goes onto the Pacemaker yet. That comes in Part 8.

1. In **REKORDBOX LIBRARY**, click the small triangles to open your folders.
2. Tick the box next to each playlist you want. Ticking a folder ticks everything inside it.
3. Click the orange **Import to Editor Library** button at the bottom (marked 2 here).
4. A message asks you to confirm. Click **Yes**.
5. Wait for the progress bar. Your new cases appear in **EDITOR LIBRARY**, and the ticks in Rekordbox Library clear themselves. That's normal.

Things worth knowing

Your playlist and the case aren't linked. If you add tracks to a playlist in Rekordbox later, the case doesn't change. To bring it up to date, delete the old case, then import the playlist again. Importing also updates the details, like title and artist, of tracks already in the app, and they stay in all their cases.

Importing twice makes two cases. The existing case isn't replaced or merged. The new one gets "_2" on the end of its name.

Don't see a new playlist? Click **Reload** at the top of Rekordbox Library. What you've ticked stays ticked.

Some tracks don't come across? Only MP3, FLAC, M4A, MP4, AAC, WAV and AIFF files can be imported. The app tells you about any others it leaves out.

Intelligent playlists work too. You get the tracks that match at the moment you import, in title order. The case doesn't keep updating afterwards.

Part 5: How cases get their names

Imported cases get a short name built from where the playlist sits in your Rekordbox folders, so you can tell them apart. You never need to work this out yourself, and you can rename any case afterwards (see Part 6).

The rules

Part of the name	What happens to it	Example
Each folder	Any numbering at the start like "08 - " is removed, then the first **4 characters** are kept.	"08 - Aug" becomes `Aug` "IYKYK" becomes `IYKY`
The playlist	Numbering is removed, then **spaces** are removed, then the first **12 characters** are kept.	"Deep or Heavy" becomes `DeeporHeavy`
Joining up	All the pieces are joined with underscores, folders first.	`2025_Aug_IYKY_DeeporHeavy`
Playlist not in a folder	The name is kept exactly as it is, spaces and numbers included. If it's over 24 characters it's cut to 23 plus "…".	"Festival Bangers" stays `Festival Bangers`

Real examples

In Rekordbox	Case name
2025 → 08 - Aug → IYKYK → Deep or Heavy	`2025_Aug_IYKY_DeeporHeavy`
2025 → 08 - Aug → IYKYK → 02 - Warm Up Selects	`2025_Aug_IYKY_WarmUpSelect`
Techno → Peak Time	`Tech_PeakTime`
Gigs → 2026 → Friday Late Night Set	`Gigs_2026_FridayLateNi`
Festival Bangers (not in a folder)	`Festival Bangers`
01 - Festival Bangers (not in a folder)	`01 - Festival Bangers`
My Absolutely Enormous Summer Playlist (not in a folder)	`My Absolutely Enormous …`

Lookalike names
Two playlists in the same folder can shorten to the same name if their names start the same way. For example, "Warm Up Selects A" and "Warm Up Selects B" both end in `WarmUpSelect`. The app adds `_2` to the second so they stay separate, but you'll probably want to rename them to something clearer.

Part 6: Rename a case

The quick way:

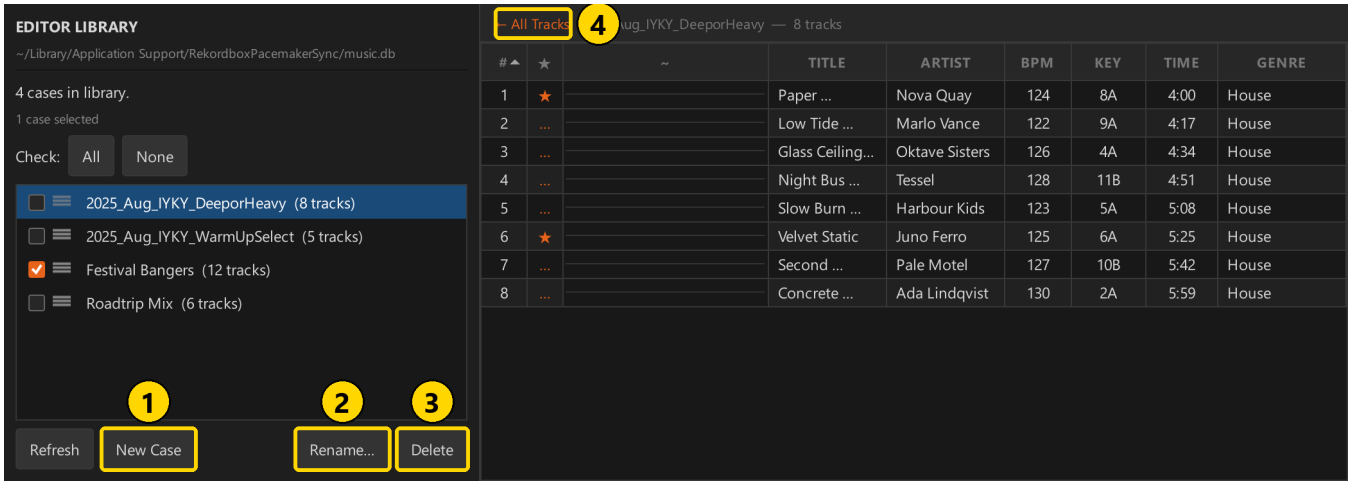
1. In **EDITOR LIBRARY**, double-click the case's name.
2. Type the new name and press **Return**. Press **Esc** to change your mind.

To rename several in a row:

1. Hold **Command** and click each case, then click **Rename…** at the bottom of the panel.
2. A box appears for each case in turn. Type a name and click **OK**. Clicking **Cancel** stops the sequence, and names you've already changed stay changed.

> **Good to know**
> Your Rekordbox playlist keeps its old name. If the case is already on the Pacemaker, the new name reaches it the next time you click **Sync**. Two cases can't share a name, so the app asks you to pick another if it's already taken.

Part 7: Create and edit cases



A case open for editing: **1** New Case, **2** Rename, **3** Delete, **4** back to All Tracks.

Create a new, empty case

1. Click **New Case** at the bottom of **EDITOR LIBRARY**.
2. Type a name and click **OK**. It appears in the list with 0 tracks. The list is alphabetical, so it may not be at the bottom.

Add tracks to a case

From tracks already in the app:

1. If a case is open, click ← **All Tracks** above the track list so you can see everything. (Or open another case to copy tracks from it.)
2. Click a track. To pick more, hold **Command** and click others, or hold **Shift** and click to select a run of tracks.
3. Drag them onto the case's name in **EDITOR LIBRARY**. The row lights up when you're over it. Let go.

From your Mac's folders: drag audio files or whole folders from Finder onto a case's name, or onto the empty space below the cases to make a new case from them. This works without Rekordbox. Supported types are MP3, FLAC, M4A, MP4, AAC, WAV and AIFF. Files in other formats are left out, and the app tells you. The app checks each file first: if one is damaged, it names the file and imports nothing, so you can fix it and try again.

> **Good to know**
> Tracks are copied into a case, not moved, so one track can be in several cases. If a track is already in the case, the app asks whether to **Add** it again or **Skip** it. The **Cases** column in All Tracks shows how many cases each track is in.

Change the track order

1. Click a case's name to open it.
2. Click the **#** column heading so the tracks are shown in their running order.
3. Drag a track up or down the list and let go where you want it. The new order saves by itself.

> **About sorting**
> Clicking the other column headings (such as BPM) only sorts the view, and doesn't change the case. You can only drag tracks when the list is sorted by **#**, so click **#** first if dragging doesn't work.

Remove a track from a case

1. Open the case and click the track (or select several).
2. Press the **delete** key. Or **right-click** it and choose **Remove from Case**: on a trackpad, click with two fingers, or hold **Control** and click.

This only takes the track out of that case. The music file stays on your computer, and the track stays in All Tracks and any other cases.

Delete a whole case

1. Click the case (hold **Command** to select several) and click **Delete** at the bottom of **EDITOR LIBRARY**.
2. Click **Yes** to confirm. Tracks that aren't in any other case also leave the app's list, but **the music files on your computer aren't deleted**.

Preview a track

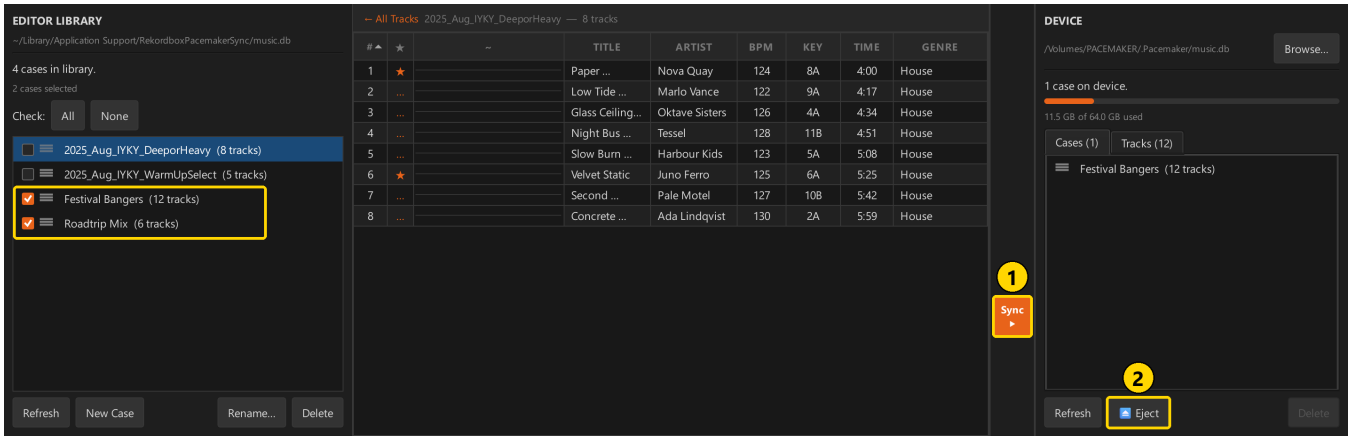
Double-click a track to play it in the player at the top. Or click inside the waveform column (marked **~**) to start from that point. Waveforms only appear for tracks Rekordbox has analysed.

Remove a track from the app altogether: tracks in no case show as unassigned in **All Tracks**. Click one and press **delete**. The music file on your computer isn't touched.

Can I edit a track's title or artist? Not in this app. Change it in Rekordbox, then import the playlist again to update it here. Your next Sync updates the Pacemaker.

Part 8: Sync to your Pacemaker

> **The one rule to remember**
> **A tick in Editor Library means "this case should be on my Pacemaker".** When you click Sync, the app makes the Pacemaker match your ticks: ticked cases get added, and unticked cases that this app put there earlier get **removed**.



Ticks decide what goes on the device: **1** Sync, **2** Eject. Festival Bangers is already on the device; Sync will add Roadtrip Mix.

Put cases on the Pacemaker

1. Connect the Pacemaker. The **DEVICE** panel fills in, and the orange **Sync** button lights up.
2. Tick the cases you want in **EDITOR LIBRARY**. Cases already on the Pacemaker are ticked for you. The line near the top shows how much music would be copied. If it won't fit, the app warns you before it starts.
3. Click **Sync**. If you're only adding cases, it starts straight away. If it would remove or change anything already on the Pacemaker, it lists the cases and asks first. Read the list, then click **Yes**.
4. Wait for the progress bar to finish. It can take a while for big cases. Don't unplug anything. To stop early, click **Cancel Sync**: it finishes the current track and keeps what's done, and clicking **Sync** later carries on.
5. Read the message in the bar at the bottom of the window, such as "Added 1 case(s) (6 tracks copied)". If it mentions skipped tracks, see Part 9.

Before every change, the app saves a copy of the Pacemaker's database to your Mac, in case anything goes wrong. It uses no space on the Pacemaker.

Eject before you unplug

1. Click **Eject** in the **DEVICE** panel and wait for "safe to disconnect" in the bar at the bottom of the window.
2. Unplug the Pacemaker.

How do I...?

I want to...	Do this
Add a case to the Pacemaker	Tick it, then click **Sync**.
Remove a case from the Pacemaker	Untick it, click **Sync**, then **Yes**. It stays in Editor Library on your computer, so you can add it back any time.
Update a case I edited or renamed after syncing it	Leave it ticked, click **Sync**, then **Yes**. The app spots what's changed and only copies new music. Changes don't reach the Pacemaker until you do this.

Before you click Yes

Removing a case from the Pacemaker also deletes its music files from the Pacemaker, unless another case uses them. Your computer's copies are safe, so you can always sync them back.

Clicking None and then Sync removes every case this app put on the Pacemaker, once you confirm.

Deleting a case in Editor Library removes it from the Pacemaker too, the next time you click Sync and confirm.

Synced to another computer?

If the Pacemaker was last synced from a different computer, the app warns you that syncing from this one will **overwrite everything on it**. It takes two confirmations before anything is erased. Click **Cancel** at either one if that's not what you want.

Good to know

Cases that were on the Pacemaker before you started using this app are left alone by Sync. They show in the DEVICE panel, and that panel's Delete button can remove them. It deletes straight away once you confirm.

Part 9: If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"No Rekordbox library found"	That's fine if you don't use Rekordbox: drag music in from Finder (see Part 7), or use **File** → **Import from M3U8**. If you do use it, open Rekordbox once so it creates your library, then click **Reload**.
"Couldn't Read Rekordbox Library"	Quit Rekordbox and reopen this app.
"Couldn't Unlock Rekordbox Library"	A newer Rekordbox may need a newer version of this app. Please report it (see below).
The Pacemaker isn't detected, or Sync stays dim	**First,** check it shows in Finder's sidebar. If not, try another cable or USB port, as some cables only charge. **Next,** go to System Settings → Privacy & Security → Files & Folders → RekordboxPacemakerSync, turn on **Removable Volumes**, then reopen the app. **Last,** click **Browse...** in DEVICE and select your Pacemaker. Its data is in a hidden folder, so press **Command + Shift + .** (full stop) to show it, open `.Pacemaker` and choose `music.db`.
"track(s) skipped (file not found)" after a sync	The app couldn't reach those music files. Check they still play in Rekordbox, and that the drive they're on is connected. Under System Settings → Privacy & Security → Files & Folders → RekordboxPacemakerSync, turn on the folders listed. Then click **Sync** again.
"Device Removed During Sync"	The Pacemaker was unplugged or lost its connection before the sync finished, so its database may be damaged. Reconnect it and check your cases. Click **Sync** to finish the job. If tracks won't load, use **File** → **Repair Device Database**. The message says where the backup of the database is.
"Tracks Would Overwrite Each Other"	Very rare. Two different files would get the same name on the Pacemaker. Move or rename one of them on your Mac, then click **Sync**.
"Import Stopped"	A file is damaged, empty, missing, or isn't what its name says. Nothing was imported. Replace or remove the files it names, then try again.
A case has 0 tracks after import	The playlist may be empty in Rekordbox, or it's an intelligent playlist whose rules matched nothing or couldn't be read. Check it in Rekordbox, then use the debug log below if it still looks wrong.
The app won't open, or says it isn't supported on this Mac	Check you're on macOS 14.4 or newer, and that you downloaded the right file for your Mac (see Part 1).
"Apple could not verify..." keeps coming back	Follow "Open it for the first time" in Part 2. If you've installed a new version, you may need to do it again.

Reporting a problem

A log file shows what went wrong, and makes a problem much easier to fix:

1. With the app open, click **Debug** in the menu bar at the top of your screen, then **Enable Debug Logging**. You need to do this each time you open the app.
2. Do whatever caused the problem.
3. Click **Debug** → **Open Log File...** to see it. The file is called `rb_pm_sync.log`.
4. Add the file to a report on the project's Issues page, along with what you did and any message you saw.

To find the log yourself, click **Go** → **Go to Folder...** in Finder's menu bar and paste in `~/Library/Application Support/RekordboxPacemakerSync`

Uninstalling

Drag **RekordboxPacemakerSync** from Applications to the Trash. To also remove the Editor Library, delete the folder above. This doesn't touch your Rekordbox library, your music files or your Pacemaker.

What's safe

This action	Your Rekordbox library	Music files on your computer	Music on the Pacemaker
Import a playlist	Not changed	Not changed	Not changed
Rename, reorder, remove a track, delete a case	Not changed	Not changed	Not changed until you next Sync
Sync	Not changed	Not changed	**Added and removed to match your ticks**

Cheat sheet

The normal routine

1. Open the app and connect the Pacemaker.
2. **Tick** playlists in Rekordbox Library, click **Import to Editor Library**, click **Yes**.
3. **Tidy up:** rename cases, reorder tracks, remove what you don't want.
4. **Tick** the cases you want on the Pacemaker in Editor Library, and untick any you want off it.
5. Click **Sync**, click **Yes** if it asks, and wait.
6. Click **Eject**, wait for "safe to disconnect", then unplug.

Quick reference

To do this	Do this
See a case's tracks	Click its name
See every track	← **All Tracks** (above the track list)
New empty case	**New Case**
Rename a case	Double-click its name
Add tracks to a case	Drag them onto its name, from the track list or Finder
Reorder tracks	Click **#**, then drag up or down
Take a track out of a case	Press **delete**, or right-click → **Remove from Case**
Delete a case	Click it → **Delete** → **Yes**
Preview a track	Double-click it
Select several	**Command**-click, or **Shift**-click for a run
Right-click on a trackpad	Two-finger click, or **Control**-click
Update an edited case on the Pacemaker	Leave it ticked → **Sync** → **Yes**